

City Council Meeting January 6th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TqWvKkwRev0
Publication Date	2025-01-07T01:53:31Z
Target Category	muncie_city

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

City of Muncie Common Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: January 6, 2025

Body: Common Council of the City of Muncie, Indiana

1. Pre-Hearing & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Statutory Public Hearings ([00:00:28](#), [00:14:29](#), [00:22:46](#), [00:23:18](#), [00:23:53](#))
- **Summary of Discussion:**
 - The council opened a public hearing regarding Ordinance 2-25 (vacating a public alley in the John J. Perkins Addition) at [00:00:28](#), then temporarily recessed due to weather until 7:00 PM [00:02:13](#).
 - Upon resuming at [00:14:29](#), public hearings were held for pending annexation ordinances:
 - **Ordinance 29-24:** Annexation Area No. 1 (portions of Farmington neighborhood). Public comment was received from John Fallon [00:14:59](#), representing an ad hoc committee of the Farmington Neighborhood Association. Fallon presented a formal petition/poll showing 40 out of 59 affected property owners (approx. 68%) opposed the annexation, meeting the statutory threshold to void the proposal under Indiana Code 36-4-3-11.1. Residents raised concerns regarding city paving plans, emergency response

times, tax increases, lack of direct notice to all property owners, and perceived lack of benefits.

- **Ordinance 30-24:** Annexation Area No. 2 (Heron Point neighborhood) [00:22:46](#) <U+2014> No public comments.
- **Ordinance 31-24:** Annexation Area No. 3 (City-owned parcel near Farmington) [00:23:18](#) <U+2014> No public comments.
- **Ordinance 32-24:** Annexation Area No. 4 (Westminster Village) [00:23:53](#) <U+2014> No public comments.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the regular monthly Common Council meeting to order following the evening hearings [00:26:50](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - *Members Present:* Harold Mason, Brandon Garrett, Jerry Dishman, William McIntosh, Jeff Green, Nora Powell, Sarah Selvie, and other council members present during roll calls.
 - *Presiding Officer:* Harold Mason (elected Council President during reorganization).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**
 - Pledge of Allegiance led by Jeff Green [00:26:53](#).
 - Invocation delivered by Jeff Green [00:27:17](#).
 - **Citizen Recognition:** Nora Powell presented the January 2025 Citizenship Award to local community organizer and writer **Moth Danner** for her extensive local advocacy, founding the Muncie Makers Market, and fostering community engagement [00:28:17](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Motion to approve prior meeting minutes made by councilman Green, seconded by Brandon [Garrett], and approved by voice vote [00:40:03](#).

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

Council Reorganization & Leadership Elections

- **Council President:** Harold Mason nominated by council; elected by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:34:02](#).
- **Council Vice President:** Brandon Garrett nominated; elected by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:36:13](#).

- **Reading Secretary:** Billy McIntosh nominated; elected by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:37:54](#).
- **Legal Counsel:** Dan Gibson reappointed as legal counsel upon motion by Nora Powell, seconded by Harold Mason (Passed Unanimously, with one abstention due to a conflict of interest disclosure) [00:14:14](#).

Public & Council Board Appointments

- **Emergency Communications (911) Board (1-year term):** Harold Mason reappointed (Passed Unanimously) [00:41:42](#).
- **Metropolitan Planning Commission (1-year term):** Jerry Dishman reappointed (Passed Unanimously) [00:42:36](#).
- **Industrial Revolving Loan Fund (1-year term):** William McIntosh reappointed (Passed Unanimously) [00:43:31](#).
- **Riverfront Project Review Committee (3-year term):** Nominees included Rose Selvie and Nora Powell. Nora Powell appointed following roll call vote [00:44:24](#).
- **Building Corporation Board (Republican appointment, 2-year term):** Troy Ingram reappointed (Passed Unanimously) [00:47:04](#).
- **Economic Development Commission (2-year mayoral recommendation term):** Jeff Green recommended (Passed Unanimously) [00:49:06](#).
- **Ethics Commission (1-year initial term):** Rev. WC Edwards appointed (Passed Unanimously) [00:50:54](#).
- **Ethics Commission (2-year initial term):** Nominees Dr. Sandra Whitaker and Dr. Charles "Chip" Taylor. Dr. Taylor appointed following a 5<U+2013>4 roll call vote [00:55:24](#).
- **Muncie Redevelopment Commission:** Andrew Dale and Zane Bishop retained/appointed [00:12:15](#).

Ordinances & Resolutions

- [01:16:30](#) **Ordinance 38-24: Ordinance Amending Chapter 77 (Parking Regulations)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Police Chief Sloan / Darren Clark / Legal Counsel.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Updates local parking regulations, infraction fines, and addresses sidewalk and driveway blocking enforcement. An amendment reflecting redline changes submitted by legal counsel was moved and adopted by voice vote [01:21:09](#).
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved as amended by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [01:23:03](#).
- [01:24:05](#) **Ordinance 39-24: Ordinance Repealing Chapter 55 (Cable Television Regulations)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Legal Counsel.

- *Deliberation Summary:* Housekeeping measure to repeal obsolete local cable television franchise regulations and commission authority now governed at the state level.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [01:25:25](#).
- **[01:24:48](#) Ordinance 40-24: Ordinance Repealing Chapter 34, Section 8 (Muncie Cable Television Commission)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Legal Counsel.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Companion housekeeping measure removing the defunct cable commission from city code.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [01:26:25](#).
- **[01:26:41](#) Ordinance 41-24: Ordinance Amending Chapter 52 (Waste and Litter Care of Premises)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Legal Counsel.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Housekeeping ordinance eliminating redundancies between chapters regarding waste and litter regulations.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [01:27:01](#).
- **[01:28:21](#) Ordinance 42-24: Zoning Amendment (4,000 Block North Morrison Road)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Ashton Land Surveyor representative.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Rezones a previously annexed parcel from R-5 (Residence Zone) to BB (Variety Business Zone) for upcoming development.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [01:29:55](#).
- **[01:30:16](#) Ordinance 1-25: Ordinance Amending Chapter 159 (Floodplain Management)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Richard Rawlings, Building Commissioner.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Aligns municipal code with updated state DNR and FEMA floodplain requirements to maintain local compliance and community insurance eligibility without increasing local insurance rates.
 - *Item-Specific Public Input:* None.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Introduced and approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [01:34:04](#).
- **[01:34:35](#) Ordinance 2-25: Ordinance Vacating a Public Alley in John J. Perkins Addition**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Alan Wisley, Attorney representing Avendale United Methodist Church.
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Vacates a 10-foot platted alley currently paved over and utilized as part of the church's parking lot, handicap spaces, and

- wheelchair ramp. Proper utility easements (AEP) are reserved, and affected adjacent homeowners retain access rights via designated parcels (B & C).
- *Item-Specific Public Input:* Attorney Alan Wisley and Pastor Ed Armantrout testified in support [01:35:05](#).
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Introduced and approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [01:39:50](#).
 - **[01:41:11](#) Resolution 1-25: Tax Abatement for Philips Pattern and Casting, Inc.**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Tracy Lutton (Muncie-Delaware County Economic Development Alliance) / Jason Paul (Company Representative).
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Approves a 3-year tax abatement for a \$370,000 capital investment in new manufacturing equipment to replace obsolete machinery, supporting the retention of 34 existing jobs. Noted as a long-standing local business since 1947 with high wage standards and low employee turnover.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [01:47:07](#).
 - **[01:47:34](#) Resolution 2-25: Fiscal Plan for Annexation (Ordinances 31-24 & 32-24)**
 - *Sponsor / Presenter:* Max Adams, Attorney (Barnes & Thornburg LLP).
 - *Deliberation Summary:* Adopts the required statutory fiscal plan for the super-voluntary annexations (city-owned parcel and Westminster Village). Legal counsel clarified this resolution pertains only to the voluntary parcels, distinct from the contested neighborhood annexations.
 - *Action & Vote Disposition:* Approved by roll call vote (Passed with recorded dissenting votes) [01:53:15](#).
-

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **[01:56:52](#) Charlie Jameson** (4501 N. Wheeling Ave.) spoke during general public comment, criticizing recent mayoral appointments to the Muncie Land Bank, specifically questioning the background of former county official Ryan Webb and expressing concern over civic leadership choices.
-

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Rob Keasling (Indiana Michigan Power External Affairs Manager) provided an update on the Northwest Muncie transmission and underground duct bank project along Tilletson Avenue and York Prairie Creek, noting construction and traffic adjustments expected through the summer [01:08:18](#).

- Council members requested that annexation Ordinances 29-24 through 32-24 be reviewed by the Land and Traffic Committee prior to the February meeting [01:54:53](#).
 - **Adjournment:** Motion to adjourn made by William McIntosh, seconded by Jeff Green; approved by voice vote and meeting adjourned [01:59:41](#).
-

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-30 02:20:12 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.